Roblox:
A Parent's Plain-English Guide

Most parents think Roblox is a game. It is not. It is a platform hosting millions of user-created games, a social network, a chat system, and an economy — all wrapped in a look that feels child-friendly. Roblox reported 24,522 child exploitation cases in 2024, up from 675 in 2019. This guide explains how it works, what the risks actually are, and what the parental controls can and cannot do.

60M+ Daily active users globally

13+ Minimum age (widely bypassed)

FREE Parental controls via PIN

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01 WHAT IS ROBLOX?

Roblox is not one game. It is a platform where users build and publish their own games, which other users then play. Over 40 million games exist on the platform. It is also a social network with chat, a friends system, and a virtual economy built on Robux currency.

Experiences
Roblox calls its games "experiences". Over 40 million exist, created by other users. Content quality and safety vary enormously.

Avatar
Every player has a customisable character. In-game items, clothing and accessories cost real money via Robux.

Text chat
Available in most experiences. Filtered but imperfect. Adults can create accounts and chat freely with no age verification.

Voice chat
Available to verified 13+ users. Increasingly used in experiences. Adds a new dimension of real-time stranger contact.

Friends system
Players send and receive friend requests. Friends can see when you are online and join your game.

Robux
The in-game currency. Purchased with real money. Used for cosmetics, game passes and creator payouts. No spending cap by default.

The child-friendly appearance is one of Roblox's biggest safety challenges. Because it looks like a cartoon, parents often assume it is safe. That assumption is exactly what some adults on the platform rely on.

24,522

Child exploitation reports on Roblox in 2024

Up from 675 in 2019.

These are reports made to the National Center for Missing and Exploited Children in the US. The UK figures are not published separately. Most incidents begin in-game and move off-platform.

WHAT PARENTS NEED TO UNDERSTAND FIRST

1 It is a platform, not a game
There is no single Roblox experience. Your child could be in any of 40 million user-created worlds, each with different content and people.

2 Adults can join freely
Anyone can create a Roblox account with no age verification. There is no mechanism to prevent adults from playing alongside children.

3 The cartoon look is not a safety signal
Roblox has a blocky, child-friendly aesthetic. This does not reflect the nature of all content or all users on the platform.

BY THE NUMBERS

60M+ daily active users globally
Roblox is one of the largest platforms in the world.

40M+ games and experiences
User-created content means quality and safety vary massively.

24,522 exploitation reports in 2024
A sharp increase in reports involving children. Vigilance matters.

02 BUILT-IN SAFETY FEATURES

Roblox does have genuine safety features. The parental controls are actually among the better ones in the gaming world. Most parents simply do not know they exist. Here is what the platform does automatically and what you can control.

AUTOMATIC PROTECTIONS FOR UNDER-13 ACCOUNTS

Applied when the correct date of birth is entered at sign-up

- Chat is restricted to Roblox's safe chat system — a filtered, pre-approved word list. Free text is disabled.
- Under-13 accounts cannot receive friend requests from users they have not already played with in a game.
- Under-13 accounts do not appear in search results and cannot be found by strangers directly.
- Voice chat is disabled for under-13 accounts. It cannot be enabled without verifying an older age.
- Social media sharing features are disabled. Under-13s cannot share their game activity publicly.
- Roblox's automated moderation scans chat in real time for prohibited content and potential grooming language.

13+ ACCOUNT DEFAULTS

What applies when your child is registered as 13 or older

- Free text chat is enabled by default. Players can type anything, filtered by automated moderation.
- Friend requests can be sent and received from any user on the platform.
- Voice chat is available but requires phone number verification to activate.
- Players appear in search results and can be found and added by strangers.
- Automated moderation still reviews and removes content that breaks community standards.
- Players can report users directly in-game — Roblox reviews all reports.

Every protection above depends on your child entering their real date of birth at sign-up. Many children register as 13+ to access more features. If that has happened, their account has adult-level defaults.

WORTH KNOWING

1 Moderation is not instant
Roblox's automated filters catch a lot, but not everything. Harmful contact can occur before moderation acts.

2 Age is unverified
Roblox relies entirely on self-reported dates of birth. There is no age verification at sign-up. Any child can register as an adult.

3 Reporting works
The in-game report function does work. Teaching your child to use it is one of the most practical safety steps you can take.

03 SETTING UP PARENTAL CONTROLS

Roblox's parental controls are set up through a parent PIN, not a linked parent account. Once the PIN is in place, you can restrict chat, contact, spending and content from your child's account settings. Unlike Snapchat or Instagram, your child does not need to consent.

1. **Go to roblox.com/parents on a browser**
   This is Roblox's dedicated parent hub.
2. **Sign in to your child's Roblox account**
   You will need their username and password.
3. **Create a PIN**
   Choose a 4-digit PIN you can remember. Do not share it with your child.
4. **Go to Parental Controls**
   From the parent hub, select your child's account.
5. **Configure the settings**
   Adjust communication, spending, content and privacy.
6. **Save settings**
   Your PIN is required to make any changes in future.
7. **Keep your PIN secure**
   Store it somewhere safe. You will need it regularly.

04 WHAT THE CONTROLS SHOW YOU

What you can manage (with your PIN)

Communication
Restrict who can message your child and who they can chat with.

Spending
Require PIN to spend Robux and set monthly limits.

Content restrictions
Limit access to experiences based on maturity and content rating.

Screen time
Set daily screen time limits for Roblox.

Account restrictions
Manage who can connect with your child and how they appear to others.

What you cannot see

Chat content
Roblox cannot (and should not) share your child's private conversations.

Experience details in real time
You will not see every game they join live. You can see recent play history.

05 THE RISKS WORTH KNOWING

Stranger contact
Adults can create accounts and talk to children. Grooming can start in-game and move off-platform.

Inappropriate content
Some experiences contain violence, horror, or sexual themes.

Scams and phishing
Fake Robux offers, links and giveaways lure children into scams.

Overspending
Children can spend real money on Robux and in-game items quickly.

Addiction and escapism
Endless games and rewards can lead to excessive screen time.

06 STARTING THE CONVERSATION

Roblox is most likely to be used safely when children feel comfortable talking to a parent.

- Ask open questions about the games they enjoy.
- Join them in a game sometimes.
- Talk about people they meet online.
- Set rules together around time and spending.
- Remind them they can always come to you.

Childline support: If you or a child you know needs support, Childline is available 24/7 at 0800 1111 or childline.org.uk.